
How to assess

Assessment in transdisciplinary education is not straightforward: discuss all the different options and any imposed limitations with relevant stakeholders before deciding on an approach. This guide presents various methods to evaluate learning outcomes, even in the unpredictable context of transdisciplinary learning. Discover useful tools and insights to ensure fair and high-quality assessments that benefit both students and other participants.

In education, learning is assessed and evaluated, in order to:

- **Guide the learning process towards certain goals and outcomes;**
- **Determine whether the learning outcomes or goals have been achieved;**
- **Award certificates or diplomas.**

Learning in transdisciplinary education is unpredictable and varied, making

assessment a challenge. It requires a critical look at who the assessment is for, what it should lead to, what the learning outcome is, and how to ensure the quality of the assessment (Gulikers, 2022).

- **Who:** in transdisciplinary education, you strive for equality among participants. Since assessment and evaluation primarily focus on the student, this can complicate the equal collaboration between students and other participants. Although little is known about specific strategies to overcome this struggle, it is important to be aware of the role that assessment plays in maintaining equitable collaboration.
- **Purpose:** do all students need to learn and develop the same things? Personal, professional, and identity development will vary. Assessment should encourage students to get the best out of themselves, rather than hold them back. This requires 'assessment for learning' (Schellekens et al., 2021), allowing for development and differences among learners ("assessment for distinctiveness") (Jorre de St Jorre & Oliver, 2018).
- **What:** learning outcomes should focus on the processes all students go through and allow for learning surprises: the unexpected learning experiences (Baggen et al., 2022; Gulikers & Oonk, 2019). Therefore, spend time and attention clarifying the success criteria, preferably together with students.

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- **How: try to change your view on the quality of assessment. Employ various methodologies and involve students and evaluators in designing them to ensure a reliable perspective (Van der Vleuten et al., 2012).**

An important competency in transdisciplinary education is 'boundary crossing,' or bridging boundaries. The [BC-rubric](#) (Gulikers & Oonk, 2019) based on this competency helps shaping an assessment framework.